

Tech Support Scam PCAP Analysis

Date: September 2026

Category: Social Engineering

Tools Used: Wireshark, VirusTotal, ANY.RUN

Scenario

We are given a pcap file that contains traffic from a redirection chain and a social engineering attack. I will analyze the pcap files using Wireshark and will also use tools like VirusTotal to check for malicious IP addresses.

Investigation

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protoc	Length	Info
13	1.020262	10.1.9.101	10.1.9.1	DNS	74	Standard query 0x560c A sd5doozry8.com
14	1.042426	10.1.9.1	10.1.9.101	DNS	138	Standard query response 0x560c A sd5doozry8.com A 198.134.112.243 A 198.134.112.2
52	2.635384	10.1.9.101	10.1.9.1	DNS	77	Standard query 0x74fb A clk.verblife-3.co
53	2.653521	10.1.9.1	10.1.9.101	DNS	136	Standard query response 0x74fb A clk.verblife-3.co CNAME adventurefeeds.xml.ak-is
61	2.804482	10.1.9.101	10.1.9.1	DNS	80	Standard query 0xa9c9 A site.topwebsite4.xyz
62	2.833452	10.1.9.1	10.1.9.101	DNS	112	Standard query response 0xa9c9 A site.topwebsite4.xyz A 104.27.184.14 A 104.27.18
109	3.443984	10.1.9.101	10.1.9.1	DNS	75	Standard query 0x96c6 A code.jquery.com
112	3.469119	10.1.9.1	10.1.9.101	DNS	127	Standard query response 0x96c6 A code.jquery.com CNAME cds.s5x3i6q5.hwcdn.net A 2

After filtering by protocol, the DNS packets stand out. There are a few websites listed within the queries.

sd5doozry8.com

3

/ 89

Community Score

3/89 security vendors flagged this domain as malicious

sd5doozry8.com

Malicious (alphaMountain.ai) top-1M

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

COMMUNITY 9

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Security vendors' analysis ⓘ

alphaMountain.ai	! Malicious
Sucuri SiteCheck	! Malicious

1

/ 89

Community Score

1/89 security vendor flagged this domain as malicious

clk.verblife-3.co
verblife-3.co

Ads/Analytics, Suspicious (alphaMountain.ai)

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

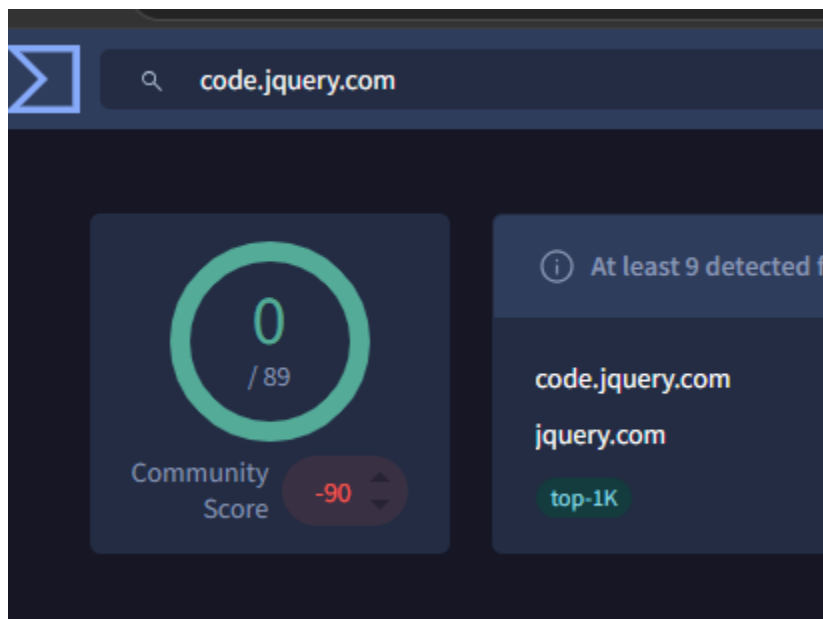
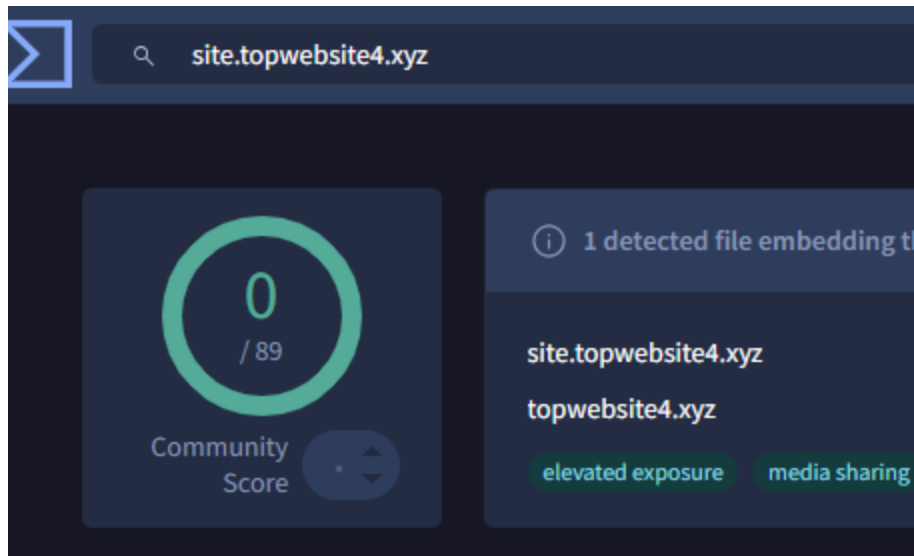
COMMUNITY

Join our Community

 and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to [automate checks](#).

Security vendors' analysis ⓘ

Fortinet	! Malware	alphaMountain.ai
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Out of all the sites, two of the websites got flagged. When checking all the IP addresses, none of them got flagged by VirusTotal. That was all the information about the DNS packets, but now I want to filter for HTTP request packets to see if they can provide further insight into what websites were visited.

http.request					
No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length Info
4	0.193780	10.1.9.101	134.249.116.78	HTTP	355 GET /jquery.js HTTP/1.1
57	2.733719	10.1.9.101	174.137.155.139	HTTP	335 GET /click?i=jwu9aD62G*M_0 HTTP/1.1
95	3.264071	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	440 GET /?browser=IE_11.0&cid=sJ5c6MftDBc&ip=173.166.146
99	3.374088	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	493 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/ HTTP/1.1
108	3.443982	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	409 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/bg-1.jpg HTTP/1.1
110	3.443985	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	409 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/bg-3.jpg HTTP/1.1
135	3.512309	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	413 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/defender.png HTTP/1.1
235	3.680764	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	397 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/sound/err.mp3 HTTP/1.1
236	3.692835	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	427 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/sound/err.mp3 HTTP/1.1
354	3.789801	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	409 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/bg-2.jpg HTTP/1.1
543	45.491601	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	396 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/security.php HTTP/1.1
546	57.192208	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	389 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/security.php HTTP/1.1
549	60.888781	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	442 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/security.php HTTP/1.1
550	60.914103	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	389 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/security.php HTTP/1.1

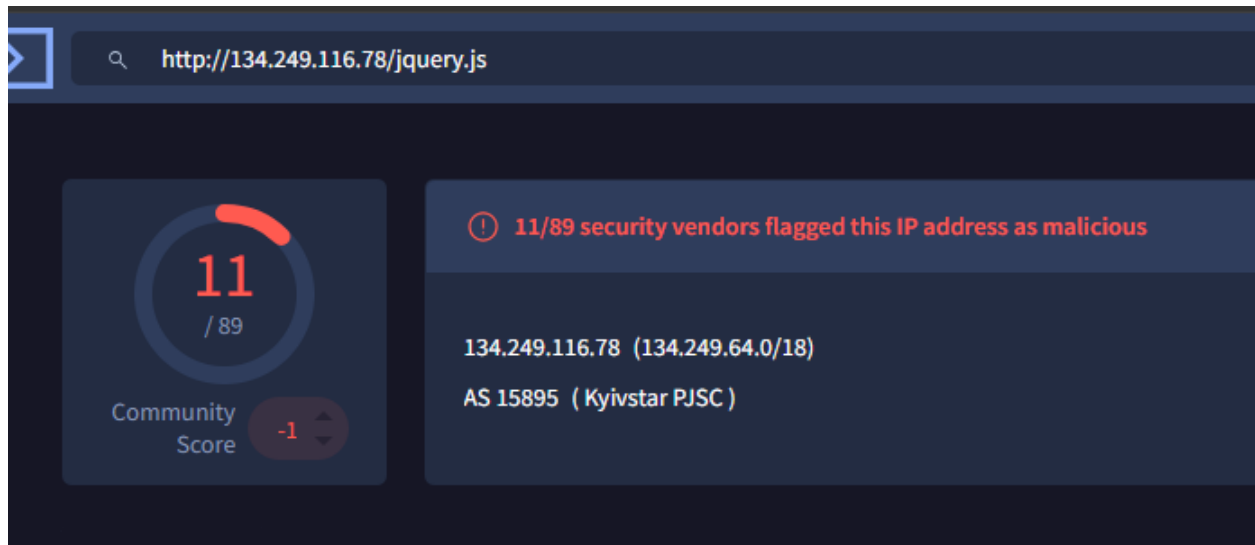
One thing I notice after the filter is applied is that the victim machine is the host with the IP address 10.1.9.101, as that is the machine trying to access websites with its HTTP requests. Another thing that can be observed is the consistent pc error messages that appear. There are only 3 HTTP request packets before the pc errors occur. I now want to see the HTTP packets with both request and response. So I applied the HTTP filter.

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length Info
4	0.193780	10.1.9.101	134.249.116.78	HTTP	355 GET /jquery.js HTTP/1.1
Frame 4: 355 bytes on wire (2840 bits), 355 bytes captured (2840 bits) Ethernet II, Src: HewlettPacka_1c:47:ae (00:08:02:1c:47:ae), Dst: Netgear_b6:93:f1 (20:e5:2a:b6:93:f1) Internet Protocol Version 4, Src: 10.1.9.101, Dst: 134.249.116.78 Transmission Control Protocol, Src Port: 49333, Dst Port: 80, Seq: 1, Ack: 1, Len: 301 Hypertext Transfer Protocol GET /jquery.js HTTP/1.1\r\n Accept: application/javascript, */*;q=0.8\r\n Referer: http://delegatesoftware.net/\r\n Accept-Language: en-US\r\n User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 6.1; WOW64; Trident/7.0; rv:11.0) like Gecko\r\n Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate\r\n Host: 134.249.116.78\r\n DNT: 1\r\n Connection: Keep-Alive\r\n \r\n [Response in frame: 9] [Full request URI: http://134.249.116.78/jquery.js]					

Another thing worth noting is that the victim uses Windows 7. Windows 7 is very old and has a lot of vulnerabilities, making it a clear target.

[Full request URI: http://134.249.116.78/jquery.js]

Looking at the first request, the user attempts to visit the website above.



When entering the URL or IP address (either will work) into VirusTotal, it gets flagged as malware.

```
581 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (application/javascript)
335 GET /click?i=jwu9aD62G*M_0 HTTP/1.1
```

The HTTP response for the request gets a 200 code, meaning a few things. A page was loaded for the user successfully; however, because it queried for a malicious IP address, chances are the user got a scam page impersonating a legitimate website.

```
57 2.733719 10.1.9.101 174.137.155.139 HTTP 302 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (application/javascript)
59 2.799796 174.137.155.139 10.1.9.101 HTTP 289 HTTP/1.1 302 Found
```

```
[Full request URI: http://clk.verblife-3.co/click?i=jwu9aD62G*M_0]
```

The user then appears to get redirected to another website, as seen with the 302 code.

```
59 2.799790 174.137.155.159 10.1.9.101 HTTP 289 HTTP/1.1 302 Found
95 3.264071 10.1.9.101 68.183.175.204 HTTP 440 GET /?browser=IE_11.0&cid=sJ5c6MftDBc&ip=173.166.146.112&
97 3.336003 68.183.175.204 10.1.9.101 HTTP 1118 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (text/html)
98 3.371690 10.1.9.101 68.183.175.204 HTTP 103 551 1.1 200 OK (text/html)

End of chunked encoding
\r\n
Content-encoded entity body (gzip): 849 bytes -> 2212 bytes
File Data: 2212 bytes
Line-based text data: text/html (65 lines)
<html xmlns="http://www.w3.org/1999/xhtml">\n
<head><meta http-equiv="Content-Type" content="text/html; charset=windows-1252"><meta name="robots" content="noindex,nofollow"
<title>Official Support Centre</title>\n
\n
<script type="text/javascript">\n
var isChromium = window.chrome,\n
    vendorName = window.navigator.vendor,\n
    isOpera = window.navigator.userAgent.indexOf("OPR") > -1,\n
    isIEEdge = window.navigator.userAgent.indexOf("Edge") > -1;\n
if(isChromium !== null && isChromium !== undefined && vendorName === "Google Inc." && isOpera == false && isIEEdge == false)\n
    // is Google chrome\n
window.location.href = "/pc-error-0xxxchxx88/";\n
}\n
if(window.navigator.userAgent.indexOf("Firefox") != -1)\n
{\n
    window.location.href = "/pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/";\n
}\n
if(window.navigator.userAgent.indexOf("Edge") != -1)\n
{\n
    window.location.href = "/pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/";\n
}\n
if((window.navigator.userAgent.indexOf("MSIE") != -1) || (!document.documentMode == true)) //IF IE > 10\n
{\n
    window.location.href = "/pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/";\n
}\n
\n
\n
\n
if (navigator.appVersion.indexOf("Mac")!=-1) OSName="MacOS"; \n
\n
var isOpera = !!window.opera || navigator.userAgent.indexOf('Opera') >= 0;\n
// Opera 8.0+ (UA detection to detect Blink/v8-powered Opera)\n
var isFirefox = typeof InstallTrigger !== 'undefined'; // Firefox 1.0+\n
var isSafari = Object.prototype.toString.call(window.HTMLInputElement).indexOf('Constructor') > 0;\n
// At least Safari 3+: "[object HTMLInputElementConstructor]"
var isChrome = !!window.chrome; // Chrome 1+\n
var isIE = /*@cc_on!@*/false; // At least IE6\n
\n
if(OSName == "MacOS" && isChrome == true) \n
{\n
    window.location.href = "/pc-error-0xxxmacxx88/";\n
}\n
\n
\n
```

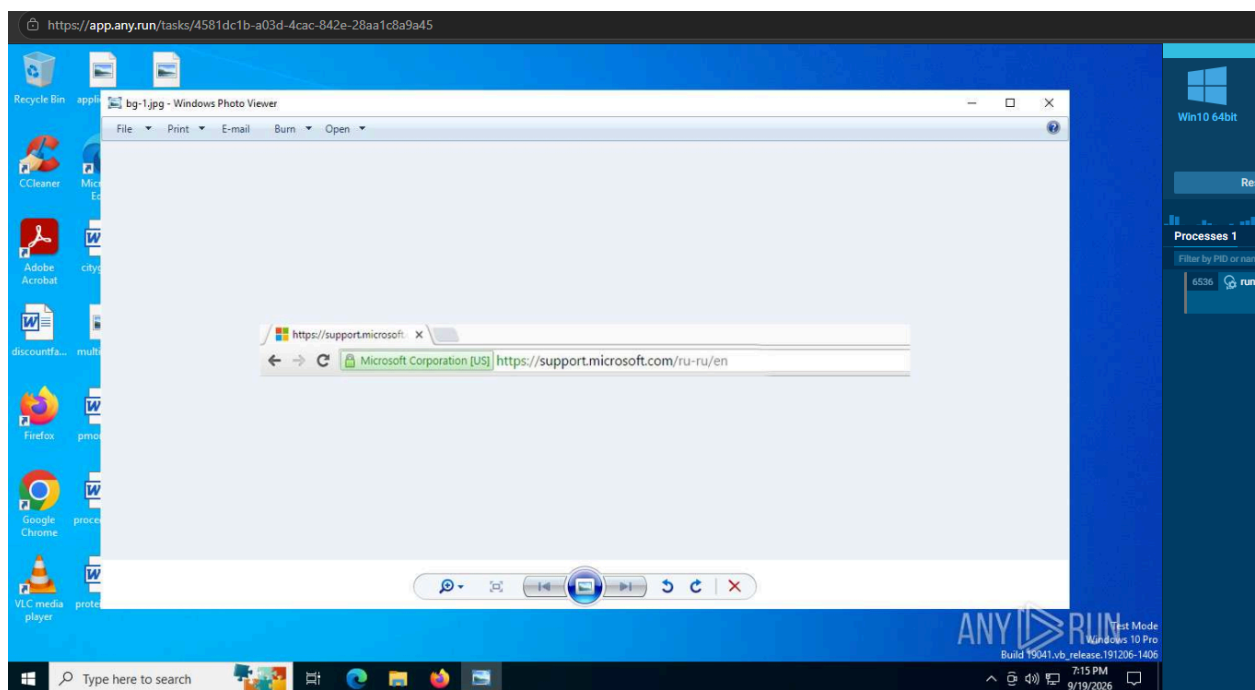
When looking at the next pair of HTTP packets, I discovered the scam website's page source. The code first tries to detect what browser the user is using, and then the source code tries to redirect the user to a given page starting with pcerror, based on their browser.

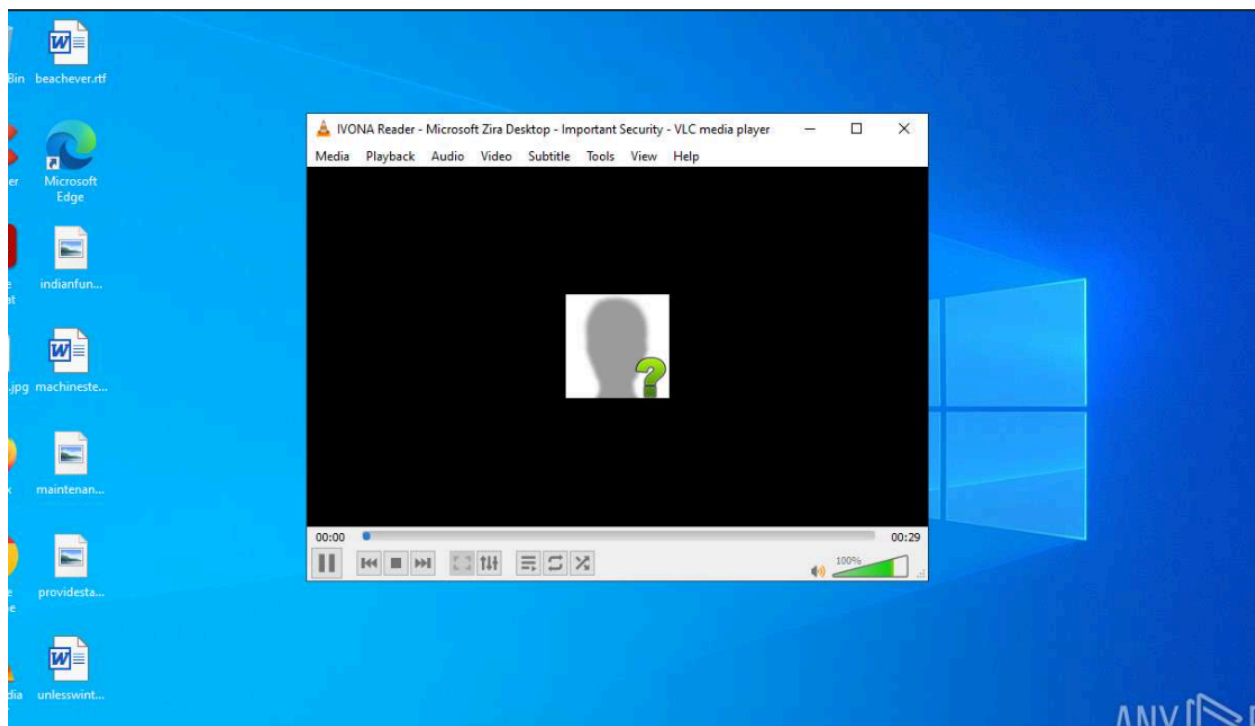
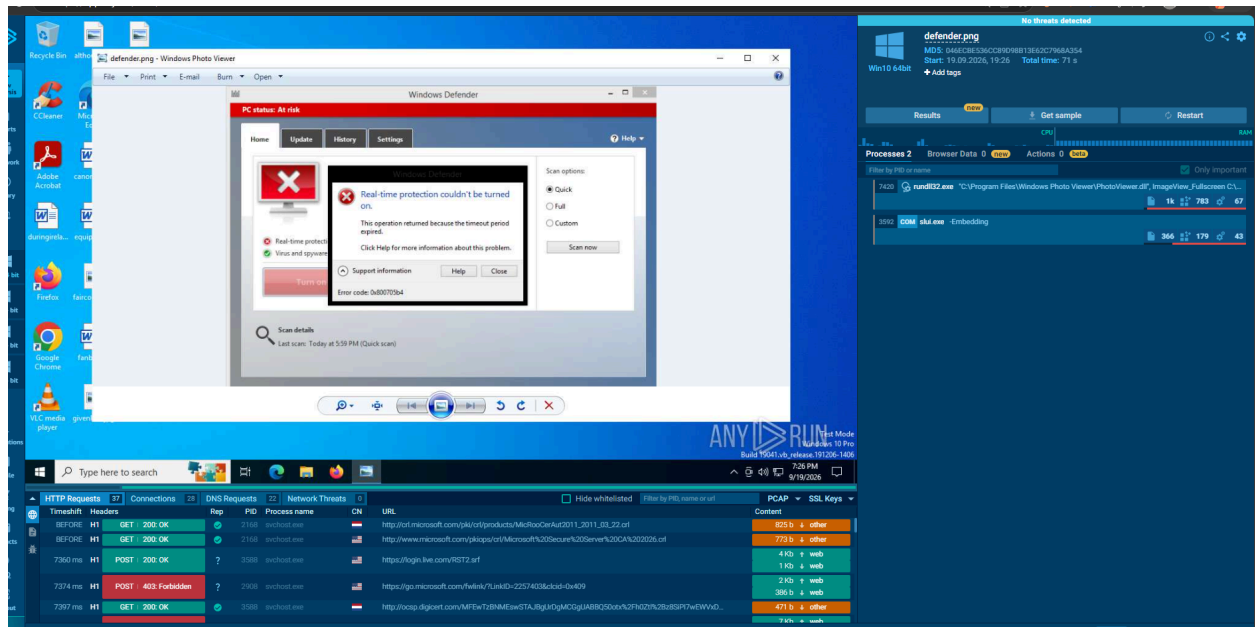
105	3.434858	68.183.175.204	10.1.9.101	HTTP	551 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (text/html)
108	3.443982	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	409 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/bg-1.jpg HTTP/1.1
110	3.443985	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	409 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/bg-3.jpg HTTP/1.1
127	3.509051	68.183.175.204	10.1.9.101	HTTP	1484 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (JPEG JFIF image)
130	3.509622	68.183.175.204	10.1.9.101	HTTP	1358 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (JPEG JFIF image)
135	3.512309	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	413 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/defender.png HTTP/1.1
235	3.680764	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	397 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/sound/err.mp3 HTTP/1.1
236	3.692835	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	427 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/sound/err.mp3 HTTP/1.1
352	3.782568	68.183.175.204	10.1.9.101	HTTP	1117 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (PNG)
354	3.789801	10.1.9.101	68.183.175.204	HTTP	409 GET /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/img/bg-2.jpg HTTP/1.1
437	3.858855	68.183.175.204	10.1.9.101	HTTP	85 HTTP/1.1 200 OK (JPEG JFIF image)
520	3.912170	68.183.175.204	10.1.9.101	ID3v1	1119

One pattern I notice after the last packet is that, once the pcerror packets start occurring, files keep getting fetched onto the victim's machine. This prompts me to look at exported objects and find these files there.

Packet	Hostname	Content Type	Size	Filename
9	134.249.116.78	application/javascript	4634 bytes	jquery.js
97	68.183.175.204	text/html	2212 bytes	?browser=IE_11.0&cid=sJ5c6MftDBc&ip=173.166.146.112&network=1321
105	68.183.175.204	text/html	18 kB	pc-error-0xxxfrnx88
127	68.183.175.204	image/jpeg	12 kB	bg-1.jpg
130	68.183.175.204	image/jpeg	3975 bytes	bg-3.jpg
352	68.183.175.204	image/png	135 kB	defender.png
437	68.183.175.204	image/jpeg	1242 bytes	bg-2.jpg
520	68.183.175.204	audio/mpeg	200 kB	err.mp3
544	68.183.175.204	text/html	40 bytes	security.php
547	68.183.175.204	text/html	40 bytes	security.php
551	68.183.175.204	text/html	40 bytes	security.php
553	68.183.175.204	text/html	40 bytes	security.php

I then choose to download these files and run them into ANY.RUN, a sandboxed environment where files can safely be tested.





After looking at both the downloaded images and sound files, here is what I've observed. The images seem to be part of the scam website; in fact, the scam website is made of these images. The sound file

seems to be an error sound effect. Altogether, this seems to be a scam website simulating an error, making the user panic. The scam website seems to be impersonating Microsoft, as seen in the first image.

The screenshot displays a network packet capture interface. At the top, a table lists three packets. Packet 551 is an HTTP 401 Unauthorized response from 68.183.175.204 to 10.1.9.101. Packet 553 is another HTTP 401 Unauthorized response from the same source to the same destination. Below the table, the details for packet 551 are expanded, showing the HTTP response structure:

```

Content-Type: text/html; charset=UTF-8\r\n
Transfer-Encoding: chunked\r\n
Connection: keep-alive\r\n
Expires: Thu, 19 Nov 1981 08:52:00 GMT\r\n
Cache-Control: no-store, no-cache, must-revalidate\r\n
Pragma: no-cache\r\n
WWW-Authenticate: Basic realm="Suspicious activity detected on your IP address due to harmful virus installed in your computer"
Refresh: 0; url=/pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/security.php\r\n
\r\n
[Request in frame: 549]
[Time since request: 0.060190000 seconds]
[Request URI: /pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/security.php]
[Full request URI: http://68.183.175.204/pc-error-0xxxfrxx88/security.php]
HTTP chunked response
  Data chunk (40 octets)
    Chunk size: 40 octets
    Chunk data: 3c68746d6c3e3c686561643e3c7469746c653e3c2f7469746c653e3c2f686561643e3c626f64793e
    Chunk boundary: 0d0a
  End of chunked encoding
    Chunk size: 0 octets
    \r\n
File Data: 40 bytes
  
```

As a final effort, the attacker tries to inject a message freaking the user out and making the user think that they have a virus on their machine.

Classification

As an end result, the user was tricked into a fake website impersonating Microsoft to possibly steal credentials, making this a classic social engineering attack. After investigation of DNS queries, the attack chain seems to be this: malicious ad -> clk.verblife-3.co — ad click tracker (packet 57) -> sd5doozry8.com — malicious redirector (302, packet 59) -> site.topwebsite4.xyz / 68.183.175.204 — scam page server (packet 97) -> Victim served fake Windows Defender alert with audio alarm -> Victim targeted with credential harvesting via security.php.

Key Takeaways

- While very few IP addresses were flagged, we could still tell if an IP address was malicious based on the HTTP responses and behaviours of the IP address.
- Malicious websites can be identified if they are flagged by VirusTotal, giving you an idea of what to look for and follow when reading the packets.